

Genre or Not: Examining the “-like” Suffix as a Category Expression

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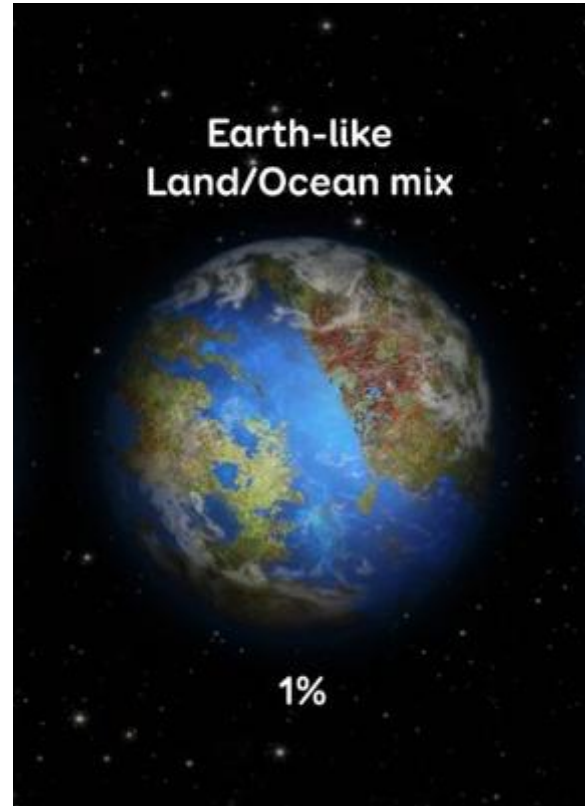
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What is “-like”

- N-like = “like an N,” used to assess and label X relative to category N.
- Use “N-like” to describe something by comparing it to a known kind without committing fully. It gives people a clear reference while keeping the claim tentative for now.

Moon, R. (2011). English adjectives in-like, and the interplay of collocation and morphology. *International journal of corpus linguistics*, 16(4), 486-513.



Earth-like planet



Bird-like dinosaur

Game genre: narratology and ludology

Narrative/Literary perspective

- Horror
- Fantasy
- Sci-fi
- Crime
- ...
- ...

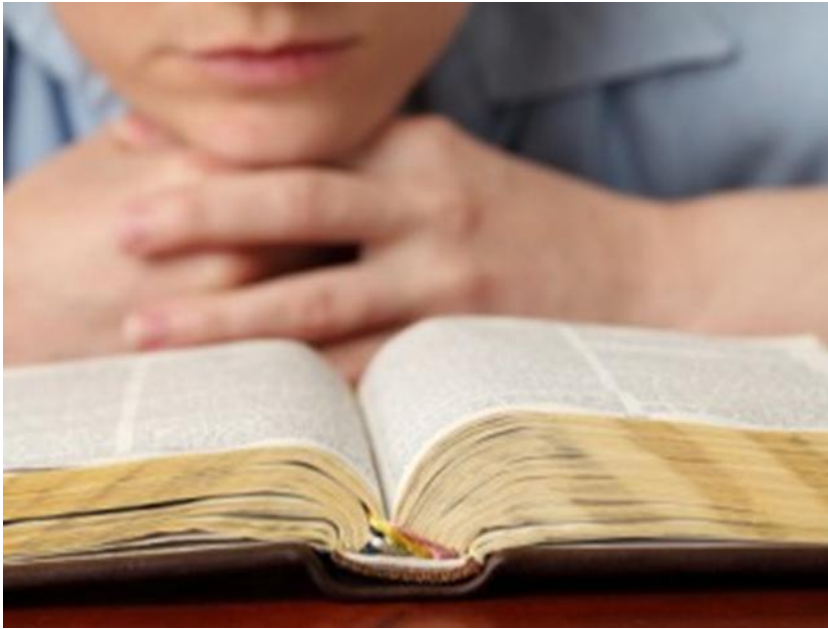
Game mechanics

- FPS
- RTS
- MOBA
- RPG
- ...
- ...

But if they are not enough...

Language as a “choice”

- Language has **meaning potential**. It has the potential to make meaning.
- When people actually use the language, this potential turns into real meanings.

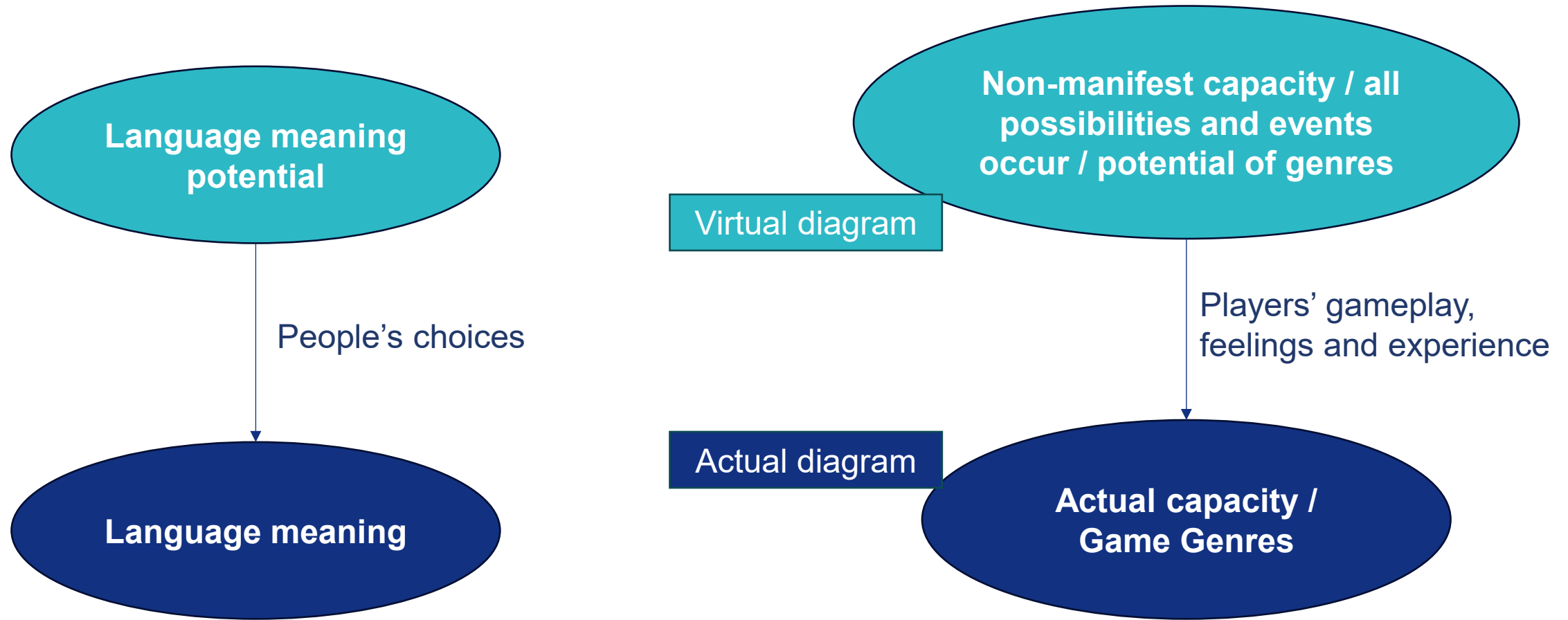


Game genre as atmospheric assemblage (Andiloro, 2023)

- **Atmosphere:** the complex of emotions, sensations, and embodied feelings of players.
- **Assemblage:** assemblages exist in the here and now, as **events**, expressive of properties that their individual components lack.
- Thinking of videogame genres as events, happening in the ‘**here and now**’ of experience.
- Players experienced as a holistic type of embodied “**looking-moving-feeling**.” The experienced quality of this event enables players to identify different video games as belonging to a certain genre.

Andiloro, A. (2023). Understanding genre as atmospheric assemblage: The case of videogames. *Television & New Media*, 24(5), 559-570.

Game genre as atmospheric assemblage



Deleuze, G. (2007). The actual and the virtual. In *Dialogues II* (E. R. Albert, Trans., pp. 148–153). Columbia University Press.

Souls-like/Soulborne games

- Horror, fantasy, grim dark; ARPG
- The soulsborne's atmosphere is hectic, tense, unforgiving. Players must be precise, patient and meticulous... The visual and sound aesthetics reinforce these affects.
- However, even when certain assemblage components change, the soulsborne diagram remains recognizable by the player as an overall experiential atmosphere.



Genshin-like games

- *The Legend of Zelda: Breath of the Wild*. Why didn't *Genshin Impact* become a Zelda-like game eventually?
- High-budget open-world; gacha mechanics; JRPG.
- Character-centric; anime-style storytelling.
- Media mix (Steinberg, 2012).

Steinberg, M. (2012). *Anime's media mix: Franchising toys and characters in Japan*. U of Minnesota Press.



Thank you



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